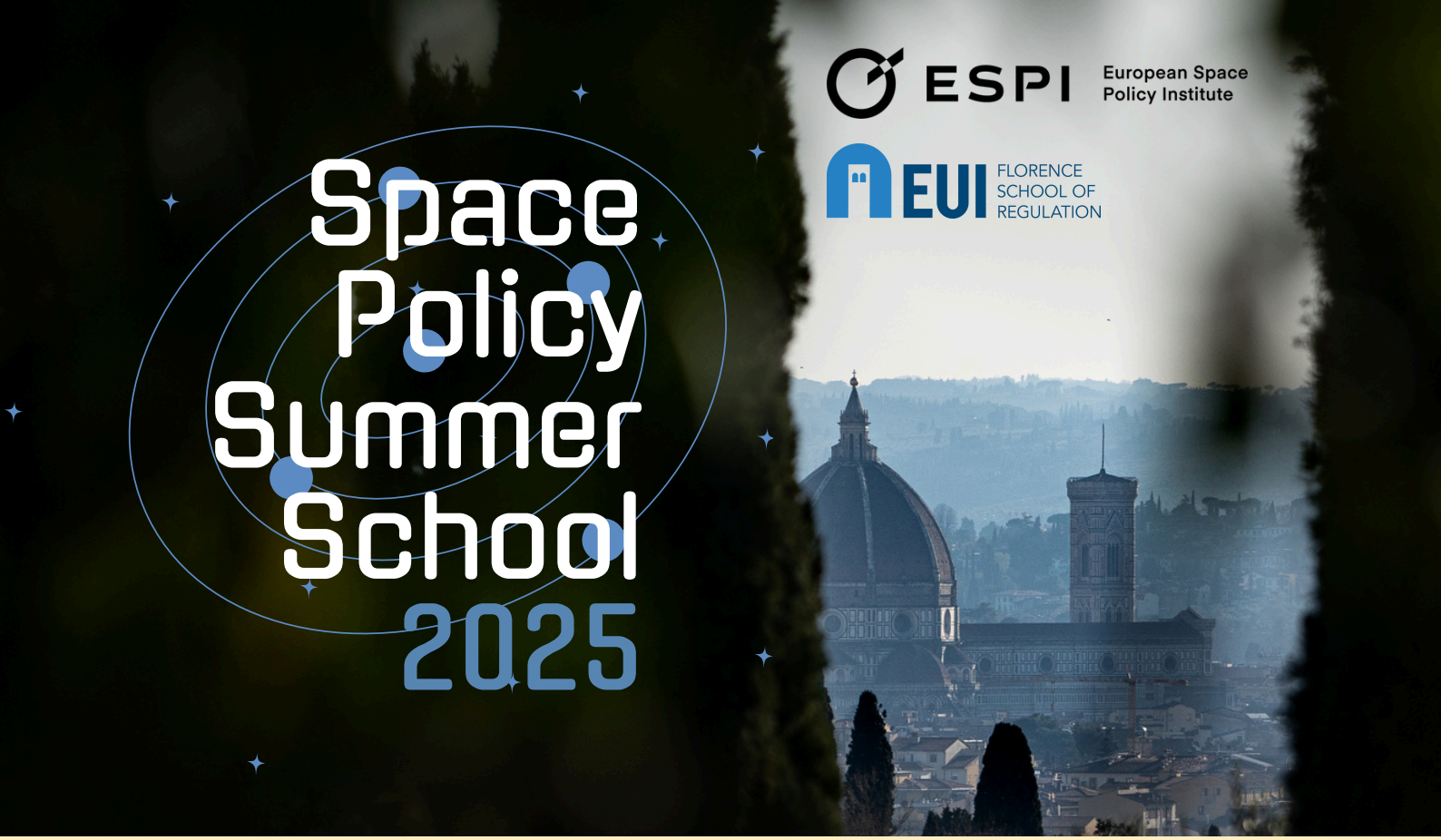


Closing the Competitiveness & Resilience Gap: THE ROLE OF SPACE

25-27 August 2025

Introduction

The role of space in tackling real-world challenges is still emerging, yet it holds the potential to transform every aspect of our daily lives, economies, and digital futures. To realise this potential, space must be firmly embedded within – and understood across – other sectors. Only then can it become a key driver in closing the innovation and competitiveness gap in Europe.

To delve deeper into these interconnections, the Florence School of Regulation, in collaboration with the European Space Policy Institute (ESPI), co-organised a Summer School on Space Policy.





Objectives

- To deliver in-depth, high-impact training on space policy and strategy
- To spark interest in the space sector among both emerging and established professionals
- To highlight the relevance of space in addressing broader societal challenges
- To create a networking bridge between professionals from the space and non-space sectors

Some Takeaways

Monday 25 August - Introduction to Space Policy

- Space: the **1.8 trillion USD opportunity.**
- **Space is already present in many aspects of everyday life** and becoming increasingly relevant now for security and connectivity.
- Although political will and financial ambitions are increasing, **Europe still lags behind major space powers**
- **Regulation vs Deregulation**: how can Europe remain competitive and resilient in a rapidly evolving geopolitical environment? How to identify the use cases that make the most (economic) sense for Europe?

Tuesday 26 August - Designing and Leveraging

- Space is **inherently intertwined with other domains** such as energy, transport, agriculture & food, but all of these domains have their own solutions. **The space sector should continue to challenge and initiate new avenues of cooperation** with these various actors. There are many common areas of opportunity and gain!
- **Threats to European security are growing**, and are oftentimes hidden in plain sight. Here is the "wake-up call" for **Europe to strive for greater strategic autonomy and to strengthen its capabilities** in critical areas.
- The space ecosystem in Europe is… complicated. Multiple stakeholders brings many different interests!

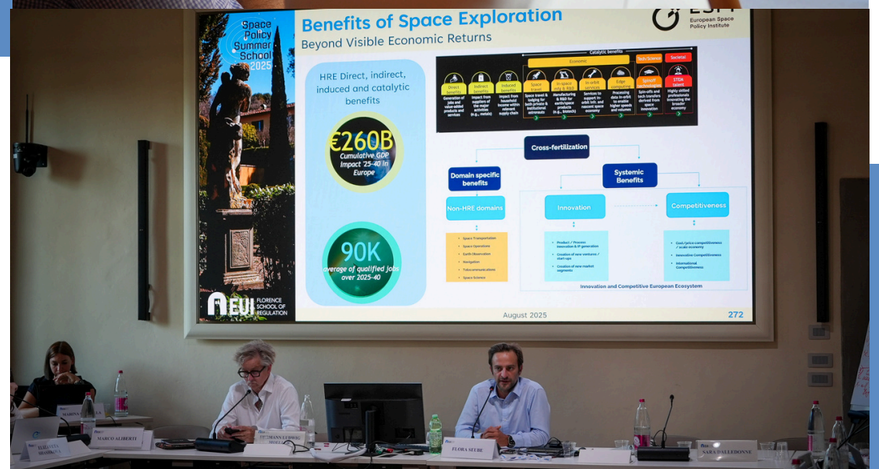
Wednesday 27 August - Industry & Policy Perspectives and Consolidation

- Space is the **ultimate cross-industry platform**.
- Digital transformation drives demand for connectivity and global coverage exponentially. **If you don't scale, you fail!**
- **European Industry must lead in global standards and ethics**, with sustainability, security, and resilience as defining pillars.
- **Empowering the next generation** of leaders in the space sector is crucial for future positive growth of the sector











Speakers



Markus Fritz
Managing Director, ADVISORIO



Fabio Gaetano Santeramo
Assistant Professor, EUI



Mariella Graziano
Executive Director of Strategy & BD for Science, Exploration and Transportation, GMV Space Systems,



Nikolai Khlystov
Lead, Space Technologies, World Economic Forum



Elena Lazarou
Incoming Director General, ELIAMEP



Piero Messina
Senior Policy Advisor, ESA



Juan José Montero Pascual
Director of the Transport Area, EUI



Eric Morel de Westgaver
Director of Strategy, Legal and External Affairs, ESA



Isabella Poldrugo
Deputy Head of Unit – Space Policy, European Commission



Jana Robinson,
Managing Director, Prague Security Studies Institute



Flora Seube
Head of European Affairs, Eutelsat Group



Sara Dalledonne
Research Fellow and Lead on EU Relations and Regulatory Affairs, ESPI



Lina Pohl
Research Fellow and Germany & Austria Relations Officer, ESPI seconded by DLR



Marco Aliberti
Associate Manager, ESPI



Laura Corbett
Research Fellow, ESPI



Elizaveta Shashkova
Research Fellow, ESPI seconded by CNES

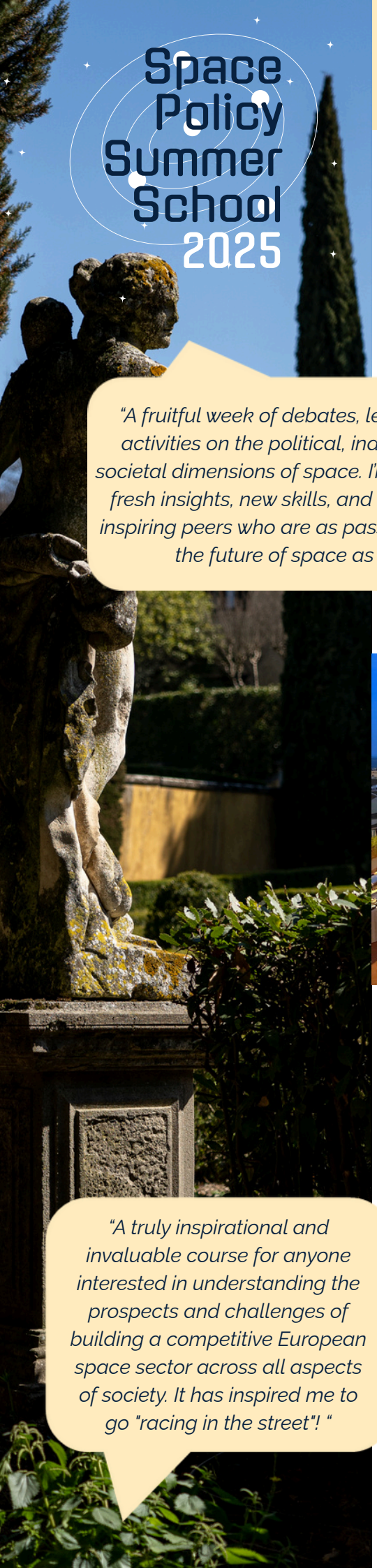
Course directors



H. Ludwig Moeller
Director, ESPI



Leonardo Meeus
Director, Florence School of Regulation



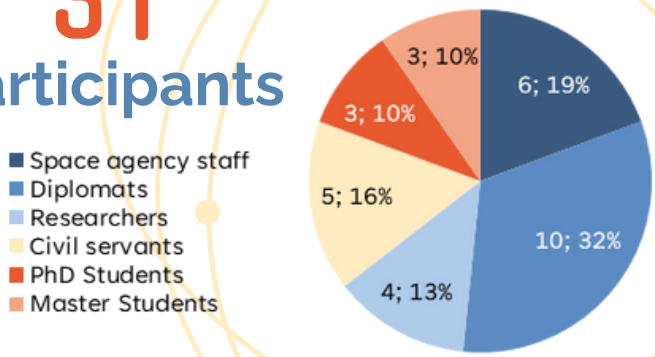
Space Policy Summer School 2025

At a Glance

3 days

16 speakers

31 participants



"A fruitful week of debates, lectures, and activities on the political, industrial, and societal dimensions of space. I'm leaving with fresh insights, new skills, and a network of inspiring peers who are as passionate about the future of space as I am."



2 social events



94,8% satisfaction rate

"The ESPI Space Policy Summer School was a fantastic experience that opened up the world of space policy in a way that's accessible, inspiring, and deeply enriching—even for those of us without a space background. It sparked a whole new perspective and transformed complex space policy topics into something exciting, relevant, and empowering."

"A truly inspirational and invaluable course for anyone interested in understanding the prospects and challenges of building a competitive European space sector across all aspects of society. It has inspired me to go "racing in the street"! "

★★★★½

4,7 average rating

ESPI European Space Policy Institute

EUI FLORENCE SCHOOL OF REGULATION